

for X, Y and Blur respectively.

Save the image and we are done with the first isolation process.

We could have skipped copy-pasting in a new template and instead opted for Crop to selection just after finishing the selection, but we didn't. This was because whenever you opt for the same method and save the image, you will never be able to get the rounded corners.



Note: The procedure of copying, pasting, cropping and providing a shadow to the selection in a new window will be used in every isolation method. So that makes it a universal method for all selections.

Isolating using the Ellipse selection is exactly the same. The only difference lies in the shape of the image. So, for circles, we use the Ellipse selection instead of the Rectangle selection.

Isolating using the Free/Lasso selection

The Lasso tool or the Free hand selection tool (also known as the polygon selection tool) is a stripped down version of the Path tool. Yet, it can be as powerful as the Path tool at times, with its own strengths and benefits. It provides easier and smoother navigation all around, when compared to the Path tool. However, it does have its own oddities. You cannot recover the path once deleted. Also, editing the path that you have created isn't as easy as in the Path tool.

The Lasso tool is very efficient if you have mastered it and if you have quite a good control over the mouse. Lasso is just perfect for isolating a polygon selection and with the Gimp 2.6, the Freehand selection got refurbished and acquired the ability of the Polygon selection, using multiple clicks. Previously you had to complete the

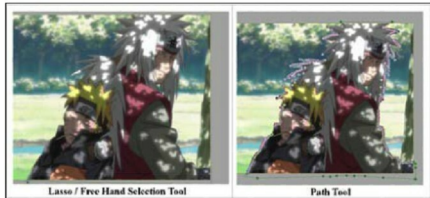


Figure 3: Difference between selections using Lasso and Path tools

selection in one go without leaving the left mouse button but now you are free to leave the mouse and complete the selection whenever you want. Working with the Lasso tool is almost identical to working with the Path tool so it will be easy to get a hang of the other, if you know the workings of any one of them.

To get started with the Lasso tool, grab the image Lasso Raw.png from the CD and open it in the Gimp. Select the lasso tool and start creating a selection from the bottom. To make the selection just click on the point from where you want to start and once you are done, a circle will appear. Move the mouse away from that point and you will notice a line stretching from that point onward; click again to create another lap. Continue doing it until you gain the shape you want to isolate.



Tip: You can make the selection process snappier by creating a significant distance between two laps. This trick comes handy when the selected part of the image has a straight section that needs to be outlined/isolated. However, when you select a curved section, keep the distance to a bare minimum—by doing this you get a very clean and smooth curved selection with less distortion.

You can start the selection from outside the image pane. As

already pointed out in the previous assignment, the Gimp selection tools will only select the part inside the image. Thus, if you have less space to work with, don't hesitate to exploit the boundaries.

So once you have opened the image, start from the boy, and then slowly and steadily form an outline. You can undo the step by pressing the backspace key; however, if you have some abnormality in the selection, just take your pointer towards the deformed part and the Gimp will display all the points/laps created with that particular region. Grab the point and holding down the left mouse button, move it to fix the misalignment. Continue with the selection and for long straight boundaries use decent gaps between the points. Join the end point with the starting point to complete the selection as shown in Figure 2. Once you have completed the selection, the Gimp will frame the selected part in an active dotted line (Active Selection), and from there you can copy paste in a new template as discussed above.



Selection Tip: If, by chance, you missed removing or adding some part in the selection, revert to the original image and while pressing Shift (to add) or Ctrl (to remove), create a selection within the original selection. Once you are done, copy and paste to finalise the selection process.